

# Predicting Chronic Kidney Disease (CKD) Using Questions

Chronic Kidney Disease (CKD) prediction involves assessing kidney function, lifestyle, existing conditions, urinary symptoms, and family history. This questionnaire method does NOT diagnose CKD but helps estimate risk and decide if further medical tests (e.g., eGFR, creatinine, urine test) are needed.

## Key Categories for CKD Screening

| Category                 | Purpose                  | Example Questions                                       |
|--------------------------|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Medical History          | Linked diseases          | Do you have diabetes or hypertension?                   |
| Urinary Symptoms         | Kidney function signs    | Do you urinate more/less often than usual?              |
| Swelling/Fluid Retention | Physical signs           | Do your legs, feet, or eyes swell?                      |
| Lifestyle                | Habits affecting kidneys | Do you drink enough water daily?                        |
| Medication Use           | Potential kidney strain  | Do you take painkillers often (like NSAIDs)?            |
| Family History           | Genetic risk             | Does your family have kidney disease?                   |
| Diet & Salt Intake       | Risk contribution        | Do you consume high-salt or processed foods frequently? |

## Common Warning Signs of CKD

- Frequent urination (especially at night)
- Foamy or dark-colored urine
- Swelling in ankles, legs, or eyes
- Persistent fatigue
- Nausea or loss of appetite
- Shortness of breath
- Lower back pain near the kidneys

## Risk Scoring Pattern

Assign scores to responses:

- ✓ No symptoms or risk factors: 0
- ✓ One mild risk factor: 1–2
- ✓ Multiple strong symptoms or diseases (e.g., diabetes, hypertension): 3–5

### Risk Levels:

0–3 → Low risk

4–7 → Moderate risk

8+ → High risk — recommend kidney blood/urine tests

Additional screening questions:

- Do you ever feel pain or pressure in your lower back?
- Do your feet or eyes appear puffy after waking up?
- Have you ever been told your creatinine is high?

**Important:**

This questionnaire only predicts risk and does not diagnose CKD. Proper diagnosis requires blood and urine tests by healthcare professionals. Early detection is critical to prevent kidney failure and improve quality of life.